

THE SIGNATURE FOR COMMON TIME

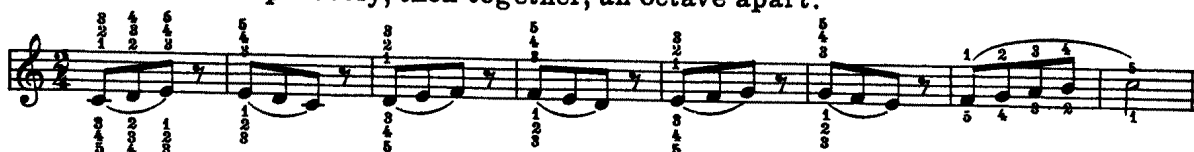
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and its origin

- A CIRCLE, the most perfect geometrical figure, was used in medieval music to indicate perfect time, *tempus perfectum*.
- ◌ THE BROKEN CIRCLE, an imperfect figure, was used to designate imperfect time *tempus imperfectum*.
- C The modern version of the broken circle, suggesting the letter C, is placed in the Time Signature to indicate $\frac{4}{4}$.

Practise this PREPARATORY EXERCISE before playing "Country Gardens"

Play the three-note groups with finger legato, tossing off each group at the end of the slur sign. There are three sets of fingers given. Each set should be studied. Practise first each hand separately, then together, an octave apart.



Country Gardens

Lively

Old English Morris Dance